

Benchmark Post Intensive Lesson Plans and Teaching Demonstration

Raymond Wagoner

School of Behavioral Sciences, Liberty University

Author Note

Raymond Wagoner

I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

Correspondence concerning this article should be addressed to Raymond Wagoner. Email:

rdwagoner1@liberty.edu

Lesson Theme Description

This week's lesson will cover the importance of and understanding of counselor and participant presence in a group counseling setting. The Theory and Practice of Group Psychotherapy by Irvin D. Yalom and Molyn Leszcz (2020) includes a chapter on what Yalom has termed the here-and-now of psychotherapy. The instructional material will come mainly from this chapter. The secondary text by Corey and Corey (2017) includes discussions on the presence of the counselor in group settings. Some information will come from these discussions found throughout the text.

Learning Outcomes

At the conclusion of this lesson, students will be able to:

LO #1: Understand the importance of presence and the use of here-and-now in group counseling related to the theory of change through interpersonal relationships.

LO #2: Explain the term process and make the connection to the interpersonal process of group counseling.

LO #3: Identify techniques of here-and-now activation in group counseling (Yalom & Leszcz, 2020).

Resources

All information for the instructional aspects of this week's class was taken from Yalom and Leszcz (2020) and Corey et al. (2017). I also retrieved a video of Leszcz's and Yalom's here-and-now in practice from Psychotherapy.net (2023) as a demonstration to further discuss the technique.

Class Knowledge

Students will need to have several prerequisite courses prior to taking this class. Counselor Professional Identity, Ethical and Legal Considerations in Counseling, Human Growth and Development, Multi-Cultural Counseling, Counseling Techniques, and Counseling Theories should all have been completed before registering for this course. This will allow the student to transfer the knowledge concerning individual counseling techniques, theories of change, and counselor/client interpersonal dynamics to a group counseling relationship. When discussing the counselor's attunement, ability to match emotion, and sense of protection through various behaviors, the student will need to have a basic understanding of these concepts to further the understanding of unique group dynamics. Building upon prior knowledge of theories and techniques will allow this lesson to be taught with a considerable assumption of the student's grasp of terminology. Also, the ability to remark on basic knowledge of theories of change built on historical counseling psychology will expedite the dissemination of novel information specific to group counseling.

Strategies

I will use a short lecture in two parts to introduce the importance and techniques of here-and-now activation (Yalom & Leszcz, 2020). I will also use experiential group learning by watching a video and identifying the aspects of here-and-now activation. Lastly, I will use active learning as the students discuss their experience with interpersonal processing in dyads.

Timeline

Time allotted	Teaching Activity	Resources Needed	Rationale
1 minute	Introduction of topic with learning outcomes (Here-and-now activation in group counseling)	PowerPoint slide	Setting the direction for the class on what to expect.
5 minutes	Lecture: What are the aspects of here-and-	PPT slides	I am reminding the students of the

	now activation from Yalom & Leszcz (2020)		material they read for the pre-class assignment. As they watch the video they will work to identify the aspects for themselves.
3 minutes	Vidoe of Leszcz & Yalom conducting a group session	Class needs paper and pens or a laptop/tablet to write reactions	I want the class to be able to identify here-and-now language and interactions for themselves.
5 minutes	Dyadic discussion of video		The prompt will be: Where did you see the here-and-now in action in this clip? Students are learning to correlate actual dialogue with the concepts being taught.
5 Minutes	Lecture: How do we understand process?	PowerPoint slides	I want the class to here the theory from me first and then we will discuss and practice.
3 minutes	Group questions: How does group process differ from individual process? Where is process important in group session? How does the counselor/leader/co-leader model process?		I want the students to think about real-life situations. Theory needs to have application, so we will apply this knowledge next.
3 minutes	Back to dyads		Prompt for dyadic discussion: Where is process difficult for you? What part of your story

			keeps you from asking deepening questions? Also, what questions do you have that are unanswered about this theory?
2 minutes	Answer questions from groups. Here main points form dyadic discussions		Allowing further synthesis of information and clarification.
2 minutes	Short personal application of how process works		I want the class to hear what here-and-now looks like in a real-life scenario. This will also wrap up the topic and send the students out with a visual of the theory.

References

Corey, M. S., Corey, G., Corey, C. (2017). *Groups: Process and Practice* (10th ed). Cengage Learning.

Psychotherapy.net (2023). *Group Therapy: A Live Demonstration*.

<https://www.psychotherapy.net/video/group-therapy>

Yalom, I. D. & Leszcz, M. (2020) *The Theory and Practice of Group Psychotherapy* (6th ed). Basic Books.

Appendix A

Grading Rubric

Lesson Plan Area	Advanced (40-50pts)	Proficient (30-40 pts)	Developing (20-30 pts)	Deficient (0-20pts)
Description	50			
Comments	I feel I synthesized the big picture of the lesson well.			
Learning Outcomes	50			
Comments	I used Bloom's language to determine what I wanted the students to learn.			
Resources	50			
Comments	I researched and used what I needed to convey the LO's without verbose complications.			
Class Knowledge	50			
Comments	I researched and applied the proper understanding of student's prior knowledge.			
Strategies	50			
Comments	My strategies paired well with my LO's			
Timeline	50			
Comments	I was intentional and clear with the what and the why of the course outline.			

I am going to write my comments as I watch:

- How wonderful you were able to get a bunch of “students” to help you!
- So here's a tip or trick: if the students have been reading something in the book- you can ask them “who remembers what the text says about....” That way you are roping people in from the beginning and getting them engaged!
- Try to get them engaged somehow in the very beginning so they remain attentive. You could even just ask them “what do you think I mean by activating phase?” Just a way to facilitate conversation and “assess” where their level of understanding is
- “What are some examples” – well done asking! I love this question 😊
 - o I'm wondering if the “clearing” of your throat is a part of the nerves? We all have them, it's so helpful to watch videos back to understand what they are for us (sort of like practicum students who watch themselves back on camera).
- Remember the power of “and”- versus “but”; the way to EMPOWER students and encourage them in the “bravery” of speaking up is to try to find the *right* in their answers. So instead of “emotions, feelings *but* its going from...” to “Yes! Bringing in the emotions, feelings, **AND** taking it even further! It's going from...” see the encouragement in the answer? (min. 7:30)
- What a GREAT activity with the video. Watching it in action, then having them chat about it later.
 - o What a powerful quote by Yalom!

- Remembering their previous knowledge too, I am thinking the term “social norms” could even be defined by your students. For example, “what do you think I mean by social norms?” and they could discuss what they remember in their multicultural class! How neat.
- Very meaningful conversation as you *process* this. Wonderful, Ray.